

Academic positions

- 2022- PRINCETON UNIVERSITY
Assistant Professor of Politics and International Affairs, Department of Politics and SPIA
Executive member, Center for Global India
Executive member, South Asia Studies Program
Faculty Associate, Data-Driven Social Science Initiative
Faculty Associate, Princeton Institute for International and Regional Studies
Member, Princeton Council on Academic Freedom
- 2023-24 *Maternity leave* (Childbirth: 21st October 2023)
- 2020-22 HARVARD UNIVERSITY
Academy scholar (post-doctoral), Harvard Academy
Research Fellow, Women and Public Policy Program, Harvard Kennedy School
- 2021-23 UNIVERSITY OF PENNSYLVANIA
Visiting Scholar Fellowship Non-Residential, Center for the Advanced Study of India

Fields Comparative Politics, Gender and Politics, Political Economy of Development, South Asia, Experiments

Education

- 2016-21 UNIVERSITY OF OXFORD, DPhil in Political Science, Nuffield College
- Dissertation, “Representation from Below: How Women Mobilize Inside Parties”
 - Dissertation Committee: David Rueda (Chair), Robin Harding, Ben Ansell, Dawn Teele
 - Mancur Olson Best Dissertation award in Political Economy, 2022
 - Juan Linz Prize for Best Dissertation in the Comparative Study of Democracy & Autocracy, 2023
- 2014-16 UNIVERSITY OF AMSTERDAM, Research Master’s in Social Sciences (cum laude)
- 2010-12 TATA INSTITUTE OF SOCIAL SCIENCES, Master’s in Arts (with distinction)
- 2004-08 IIIT, B.Tech in Computer Science and Engineering (cum laude)

Book Manuscript

“Representation from Below: The Grassroots Origins of Women’s Political Power in India”

Forthcoming, *Cambridge University Press*, *Cambridge Studies in Comparative Politics Series*

- Expected print publication by Nov 2026.
- Opinion Editorial Indian Express based on the book - ([May 2024](#)) and ([Sep 2023](#)).

Peer-reviewed publications

1. Goyal T. 2024 “[Do Citizens Enforce Accountability for Public Goods Provision? Evidence from India’s Rural Roads Program](#)” *Journal of Politics* 86:1 97-112.
 - Featured on Economic Times front page during India’s National Elections ([here](#)), 16th May 2019
 - Journal of Politics blog post ([here](#))
2. Goyal T. 2024 “[Representation from Below: How Women’s Grassroots Party Activism Promotes Equal Political Participation](#)” *American Political Science Review* 118(3), 1415–1430.
 - APSA Kauffman Foundation Award for Best Paper on Entrepreneurship and Inclusion, 2020
3. Goyal T, Sells C. 2024 “[Descriptive Representation and Party Building: Evidence from Municipal Governments in Brazil](#)” *American Political Science Review* 118(4):1840-1855.
 - Jack Walker Article Award, Political Organizations and Parties Section APSA, 2025

4. Goyal, T. 2025 “Local political representation as a pathway to power: A natural experiment in India” *American Journal of Political Science* 69: 516–530.
 - Top 10 most cited articles, AJPS (2025)
 - The Lawrence Longley Award, Representation and Electoral System section APSA, 2026
 - King’s Quantitative Political Economy Seminar Award for Best Paper, 2021
5. Van Noort S, Goyal T. 2026 “Is Ethnic Violence Self-Perpetuating? Natural Experimental Evidence from Hindu-Muslim Riots in India,” *Journal of Conflict Resolution* 70(6), 1070-1094.

Working Papers

- “Husbands-in-office: Institutional constraints against spousal succession in India’s rural local elections,” with Tanisha Mohapatra
- “Same-gender competition enables women’s political careers in Indian local government,” with Tanisha Mohapatra
- “Religious Identity Expression in India: Evidence from 505 millions voter records” with Feyaad Allie, Viktor Enssle, Saad Gulzar, and Gufran Pathan.
- “Politicians discriminate when women claim their rights: Evidence from experiments with India’s rural politician,” with Sam van Noort & Mats Ahrenshop.
- “Responsibility Information and Electoral Accountability: Evidence from India” with Robin Harding.
- “Mobilizing Millions: Programmatic ground campaigns in India’s patronage democracy.”

Policy Reports

- “Representation, discrimination and progressive social policy: Evidence from India” (2021) *IGC Final Report* with Sam van Noort.

Awards, Grants, and Fellowships

- Lawrence Longley award for best published article, Representation and Electoral Systems Section APSA, 2026
- University Committee on Research in the Humanities and Social Sciences (UCRH&SS), 7,700\$ grant for research titled, “Knowledge is Power,” 2026
- PIIRS, Princeton University 60,000\$ grant for research titled, “Knowledge is Power,” 2026
- Data-Driven Social Science (DDSS), Princeton University 20,000\$ grant for research titled, “Knowledge is Power,” 2023
- Jack Walker Article Award, Political Organizations and Parties Section APSA, 2025
- Susan Clarke Young Scholar Career Award, Urban and Local Politics Section APSA, 2025
- Seed grants for exploratory research, Center for Global India, Princeton University, 45,000\$ grant, 2024
- Seed grants for exploratory research, Center for Global India, Princeton University joint with Saad Gulzar, 50,000\$ grant for research titled, “Religious Identity Choice: Evidence from a Billion Indian Names,” 2024
- Inclusive Pedagogy Grant, The McGraw Center for Teaching and Learning, Princeton University (1,800\$)
- University Committee on Research in the Humanities and Social Sciences (UCRH&SS), 7,700\$ grant for research titled, 2022
- Data-Driven Social Science (DDSS), Princeton University 25,000\$ grant for research titled, “Religious Identity Choice: Evidence from a Billion Indian Names,” 2023
- APSA Juan Linz Prize for Best Dissertation in the Comparative Study of Democracy & Autocracy, 2023 (1,000\$)
- APSA Mancur Olson Best Dissertation award in Political Economy, 2022 (100\$)
- King’s Quantitative Political Economy Seminar Award for Best Paper, 2021 (200 pounds).
- APSA Kauffman Foundation Award for Best Paper on Entrepreneurship and Inclusion, 2020 (500\$).
- Seed grants for exploratory research, Center for Global India, Princeton University, with Amaney Jamal (50,000\$), 2020.
- Research Grant, Bobst Center, Princeton University (5,000\$), 2020.
- Nuffield-Yale Exchange Fellowship, 2019.

MIT Governance Lab grant, “Representation from Below: How Party Workers Shape Descriptive and Substantive Representation” (14,990\$), 2019.

Ostrom Fund, APSA Centennial Center for Political Science and Public Affairs (2,500\$), 2019.

Nuffield grant for travel, University of Oxford (11,000\$), 2016-2020.

International Growth Center- Co-Principal Investigator with Sam van Noort (52,000\$), 2019.

John Fell Fund, University of Oxford grant with Robin Harding (46,000\$), 2018.

Holland Scholarship, Dutch Ministry of Education, Netherlands (4,500\$).

Amsterdam Merit Scholarship, University of Amsterdam, Netherlands (31,500\$).

German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) scholarship, Germany (8,500\$).

Internal Invited Events: Princeton University

2026: “An Era of Women’s Rights” CGI panel with Gabrille Kruks-Wisner and Jennifer Piscopo

2025: Book talk with Yamini Aiyar, 10th Nov 2025

Conference on Populism and Democracy, CSDP, 25-26 April 2025

CGI event, “Why are millions of women missing in India’s workforce,” together with Ashwini Deshpande and Seema Jayachandran. 7 April 2025

PU-Sciences Po workshop, March 2025

SPIA Faculty Forum, January 2025

2024: (Mis)representation in Politics- Panel discussion- 100th Anniversary Celebration of the Department of Politics

CGI event, India’s historic elections & after: Does India’s diversity safeguard her democracy? With Ashutosh Varshney and Milan Vaishnav

2023: Research Program in Development Economics Lunch Seminar

CGI event, Social Inequality and Sustainable Development in India: Perspectives & Methods Across Disciplines

2022: Guest Lecture in ENV 343: Inequality and Sustainability in India and USA: An Interdisciplinary Global Perspective

Politics of India guest lecture, Princeton University

PIIRS Global Existential Challenges: Gender, Sexuality, and Reproductive Rights Around the Globe, [link](#) to event page.

Recent Invited Talks/ Panels

2027: University of Notre Dame

2026: UCSD, Stanford CP seminar, University of Copenhagen, Aarhus University, 32nd All India Conference of State Election Commissioners

2025: EPSA pre-conference on South Asia, Stanford, UCSD, Ashoka University, Science Po, Duke University, University of Houston - Hobby School of Public Affairs, Università Bocconi, University of Copenhagen, Aarhus University, Columbia University, University of Amsterdam, Uppsala University, Petralia workshop, NYU I&I seminar, Local Political Economy Conference (UPenn), Harvard Academy Reunion, Harvard-Brown Joint seminar, Yale, Vanderbilt.

2024: UC Berkley, Political Economy Workshop at CASI, ECPG (Ghent), EGEN, Wash U, University of Minnesota; Political Economy Colloquium and MEAD, UW Madison.

2023: PE conference, Stockholm University, Research Program in Development Economics, Princeton University, Princeton Women in Politics, Mentoring dinner for graduate students; CGI Sustainability and Inequality Panel, Princeton University; Political Economy Workshop at CASI, University of Pennsylvania; Charting Net-Zero Carbon, Climate Resilient Transitions, New Delhi.

2022: Conference on Political Elites (Columbia University), Temple University CP Seminar; EPSA roundtable on Gender Inequality in Political Science; Scope Conditions; Weatherhead Forum, Harvard University; NYU CP Seminar; Harvard India Conference.

2021: Interpreting Politics and the Rudolph Legacy Authors meet Critics event at BU (Panelist); Building a Capable State, IDFC Institute series supported by the Gates Foundation; London School of Economics; Tulane

University; Women Lead Conversations (Podcast); South Asia Joint Seminar: Harvard-Brown-MIT; CASI seminar series- University of Pennsylvania; Interpreting Politics and the Rudolph Legacy: Authors meet Critics, Boston University.
 2020: Harvard PE of D lecture, Princeton University; Quality of Government Institute, Gothenburg.
 2019: IGC Gender and Development Conference, Bihar; MIT, Chicago-Harris, and Princeton (Job talks); CSR - CSH seminar, New Delhi.

Conference/ workshop participation

2026: MPSA, APSA
 2025: CEPR (Brussels), Politics & Gender Conference (Rutgers University), EPSA (Madrid), MPSA (Chicago)
 2024: APSA (Philadelphia), EGEN (NYU), New Research on Gender in Political Psychology Conference (Brandeis University), PacDev (Stanford), 20 Years of the Quality of Government Research: taking stock and moving forward" conference (Gothenburg), EPSA (Cologne), MPSA (Chicago), APSA (Philadelphia)
 2023: EGEN (Cornell)
 2022: ISID, Local Political Economy Conference (McGill university), APSA, EPSA, Identity & Politics in South Asia Workshop UC Berkley, AALIMS, Harvard PE of D workshop, Harvard CP Workshop, Harvard PE workshop, Conference on Gender and Politics at Harvard, Scheduled: APSA, EPSA, UC Berkley India Conference
 2021: Harvard Academy seminar, Harvard PE Workshop, Harvard CP Workshop, Gender & Politics in South Asia Workshop UC Berkley, Kings QPE seminar, APSA
 2020: New Research on Gender and Political Psychology Conference, Harvard Experiments in Political Science conference, APSA, University of Gothenburg, EPSA, Oxford-LSE graduate seminar
 2019: NYU Graduate workshop, NEWEPS Columbia, pre-APSA South Asia conference at the World Bank, APSA, Centre for Policy Research Urban Workshops in New Delhi, EPSA, Oxford-LSE graduate conference, UCL graduate conference, Centre for Experimental Social Sciences colloquium at Nuffield College, IMEBESS, PSA (Nottingham), MPSA

Teaching and Advising

POL 351 Politics of Development (revised undergraduate lecture), Spring '25 and Spring '27
 POL 357 Gender and Development (new undergraduate lecture), Spring '23, Spring '25, and Fall '26 (Awarded the Inclusive Pedagogy Grant)
 SPI 404 Global Gender Gaps: A Quantitative Approach (new undergraduate seminar), Spring '23, Spring '25, Spring '27
 Introduction to Statistics for MPhil & DPhil students at the Q-Step centre, University of Oxford, 2017
 UNDERGRADUATE THESIS ADVISING: Susan Baek (SPIA, 2023 - Winner of Outstanding Thesis Willard Thorp Prize, Effron Center for the Study of America), Preeti Cheemti (SPIA, 2023), India Weir (Politics, 2023), Jane Markley (Politics, 2023), Ryan Ives (Politics, 2025), Arav Jagroop (Politics, 2025)

GRADUATE ADVISING: Nancy Yun-Tang, James Gillman

LONG-TERM RESEARCH ASSISTANTS/ PRE-DOCS: Ayushi Gupta (MPP - Harvard Kennedy School), Haniya Rumaney (PhD Psychology - CUNY), Siddarth Venkatesh (PhD Economics - Chicago), Viktor Enssle (PhD Politics - University of Oxford), Gufran Pathan (PhD Government, Harvard University), Tanisha Mohapatra (post-doctoral fellow, Max Planck), Rishabh Bijani

Professional Service

REVIEWER FOR: World Bank Economic Review, *Economica*, *NSF*, NEUDC, Journal of Development Economics, European Journal of Political Economy, Public Choice, American Journal of Political Science; American Political Science Review; British Journal of Political Science; Comparative Political Studies; Journal of Politics; World Politics; Electoral Studies, Politics & Gender.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS: *EGAP* member, *JPAL (Invited Researcher)*; *The Political Economy UK Group (Associate Member)*, *Academic Freedom Alliance* member

CONFERENCES/ WORKSHOPS ORGANIZED

2026: Gender and Politics Workshop, Fall 2026, Princeton University (co-organized with Jennifer Piscopo) 2026: South Asia Politics Workshop, pre-APSA 2026, Harvard University (co-organized with Mashail Malik, Feyaad Aalie, and Akshay Dixit)

2026: Conference on women and parties, at Aarhus University (Co-organized with Merete Seeberg)

2026: Featured Books event, at MPSA

2026: Three decades of research on India's gender quotas (co-organizing with Don Green and EGAP, MPSA)

2025: South Asia Politics Workshop, pre-EPISA 2025, Madrid (co-organized with Mashail Malik and Simon Chauchard)

2024: South Asia Politics Workshop, pre-APSA 2024, Philadelphia (co-organized with Mashail Malik)

2022: Mini-Conference on Comparative Politics of Gender in the Global South, APSA 2022, Montreal (co-organized with Bhumi Purohit, Jessica Gottlieb, Tiffany Barnes)

2019: Political Economy of Development and Accountability Conference, University of Oxford (co-organized with Robin Harding)

2018-19: Founder, DPhil Politics/International Relations Nuffield Graduate Seminar

PRINCETON UNIVERSITY SERVICE

2023-24: Organizer, Comparative Politics Seminar with Elizabeth Nugent

2022-23: Organizer, Comparative Politics Seminar with Andreas Wiedemann

DISCIPLINARY SERVICE

2025: Section Chair, Representation and Electoral Systems, MPSA.

2024: Juan Linz Dissertation Award, Democracy and Autocracy Best Dissertation committee

2023: Award committee member, Political APSA Political Economy Section, William Riker Best Book Award

2023-: Associate Editor, World Politics

Work Experience

2012-13: Analyst (Global Analyst Program), Deutsche-Bank AG Mumbai/ London/ Singapore

2008-09: Associate Software Engineer (SAS certified), Accenture, New Delhi

Languages

Hindi (native), English (fluent), Sanskrit (intermediate), French (A2 level), Dutch (A2 level)

Fieldwork

New Delhi, Bihar, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Maharashtra, Karnataka (India)

Citizenship

India & Permanent resident/ green card: USA